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Need to know: The latest version of Desktop Maestro includes new tools to manage your Windows services, control startup programs and uninstall applications. A one-year subscription will cost only Rs.2,194, a 20 per cent saving on the usual price, and you'll find more details on this (and discounts for other PC tools applications) at www.pctools.com/en/desktop-maestro/free/promo/VNU0908/

PC Tools Spyware Doctor 6 Starter Edition

Keep your computer spyware-free with one of the best malware detectors on the market

Windows Defender is a welcome addition to Vista's security tools, but it's a good idea to install a specialist anti-spyware tool ready to deliver a second opinion and PC Tools Spyware Doctor is one of the best.

The first plus point you'll notice is the program's speedy scanning engine. Some anti-spyware tools take an hour or more to trawl through your hard disk, but PC Tools Spyware Doctor can check the most commonly infected areas in around five minutes. The results of the scan are categorised according to their severity: low, medium or high. Each threat is colour-coded, too, which means you can see at a glance whether there's anything to worry about. And whatever the program has uncovered can then be deleted with a single click.

Spyware scans are useful, but of course can only pick up spyware after it has infected your PC. So it's good to see that PC Tools Spyware Doctor 6 Starter Edition also includes a real-time protection system called IntelliGuard.



System requirements: Windows 2000/XP/Vista, 60MB hard disk space

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Need to know: Upgrade to the full version of Spyware Doctor and you'll get much improved real-time protection with guards to monitor your browser and network settings, startup programs, running processes and more. Prices are Rs.2,124 for a 12-month Spyware Doctor licence, or Rs.2,832 for Spyware Doctor with a full anti-virus engine, and the program is licensed to protect up to three PCs. Visit www.pctools.com to find out more.

Titan Backup 1.5

Freedom to choose whether to back up emails, program settings or your entire hard disk

Windows Vista comes with a simple file backup tool, but this offers very little control. There's an option to back up all the images on your hard disk, for instance, but no way to be more selective.

You can't choose to back up everything in your Pictures folder, for instance, even though that's precisely the kind of function that people really need.

Install Titan Backup 1.5 and you won't have to worry about that kind of limitation any more. It can back up files by category, just like the Windows tool, so it's easy to save all your video or music. But the program also lets you back up the Registry, your email, application settings, or whatever files and folders you'd like, just by checking a few boxes.

Your backup files can be compressed to improve performance, encrypted to prevent anyone else from reading confidential files,

